

SENATE RESOLUTION 361

By McNally

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of James Harding Pratt.

WHEREAS, the members of this legislative body were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of James Harding Pratt; and

WHEREAS, James Pratt was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who distinguished himself as an award-winning journalist, a top aide to U.S. Senator James Sasser, and a government relations executive in the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, born in Cleveland, Ohio, on August 13, 1954, to Joseph James Pratt and Virginia Kendrick Pratt, Mr. Pratt moved to Memphis with his family as a child and went on to attend East High School in Memphis and graduate from the University of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, James Pratt joined *The Tennessean* as a copy desk editor, but his talent as a reporter and writer soon caught the attention of legendary editor John Seigenthaler, who ultimately assigned Mr. Pratt to some of the newspaper's toughest stories, including the Butcher banking empire collapse series for which he won a National Headliner Award and the Bill Boner investigative series, for which he and his fellow reporter Joel Kaplan received a Pulitzer Prize nomination in investigative reporting; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his time as an investigative reporter, James Pratt served as a city beat, business, and Capitol Hill reporter and a city desk editor; he left *The Tennessean* in 1989 to work for U.S. Senator James Sasser in Washington, D.C., first as his press secretary and then as director of communications for the U.S. Senate Budget Committee; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Pratt joined the Ingram Group in 1995 and became a partner, and in 1999, he founded his own government relations firm, which is known today as Pratt Government Strategies, Inc.; although he retired in 2017, the business is still family operated; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Pratt was deeply devoted to his family and always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, left to mourn his memory and carry on his legacy are his daughter, Kendrick Phillips Pratt; his former wife, Molly Leach Pratt; his sister, JoAnn Pratt Danna; his brother, Richard Kendrick (Durenda) Pratt; and his nephews, Nicolas Joseph Danna and Richard Kendrick Pratt, Jr.; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Pratt leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor the memory of James Harding Pratt, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Pratt.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.